

played a capacity to recreate the oppressive practices of the countries that they had fled. Once again persons of minority faiths were persecuted, and again such persons were subjected—this time by the colonial governments—to tithes and taxes for support of religion. *Id.*, at 10, and n. 8; *Reynolds v. United States*, 98 U. S. 145, 162–163 (1879).

“These practices became so commonplace as to shock the freedom-loving colonials into a feeling of abhorrence. The imposition of taxes to pay ministers’ salaries and to build and maintain churches and church property aroused their indignation. It was these feelings which found expression in the First Amendment.” *Everson, supra*, at 11 (footnotes omitted).

In 1784–1785, before the adoption of the Constitution, the continuing conflict between those who saw state aid to religion as but the natural expression of “commonly shared” religious sentiments, and those who saw such support as a threat to the very notion of civil government, culminated in the battle fought in the Virginia House of Delegates over “a bill establishing provision for teachers of the Christian religion.”¹³ *Reynolds, supra*, at 162–163. The introduction of that bill in the state assembly prompted James Madison to prepare and circulate his famous “Memorial and Remonstrance Against Religious Assessments,” imploring the legislature to establish and maintain the complete separation of religion and civil authority, and thus to reject the bill. In the end, the bill was rejected by the Virginia Legislature, and in its place Madison succeeded in securing the enactment of “A Bill for Establishing Religious Freedom,” first introduced in the Virginia General Assembly seven years earlier by Thomas Jefferson. 98 U. S., at 163; *Everson*, 330 U. S.,

¹³ The bill, and Madison’s Remonstrance, are both appended to the dissenting opinion of Justice Rutledge in *Everson*. *Id.*, at 63–74.